

Corpus Linguistics

Reading argument 1

Name: _____ ID: _____

Question 1 According to the text, what is the key insight regarding errors like “was happened”?

- (A) They were newly discovered in the 1980s by SLA researchers studying beginner-level ESL students.
- (B) Although noted in the 1970s, they later became recognized as being specific to certain verbs.
- (C) They were proven in the 1970s to occur randomly across all categories of intransitive verbs regardless of learner level.

Question 2 Why does the author introduce the “Unaccusative Hypothesis” right after introducing the student errors?

- (A) To explain the theoretical framework showing why this specific class of intransitive verbs has unique properties compared to other intransitives.
- (B) To argue that second language learners must be explicitly taught these complex grammar rules in the classroom, so they become more competent.
- (C) To demonstrate that unaccusative verbs are easier for L2 learners to acquire than transitive verbs, thusly showing heterogeneity among verbs.

Question 3 According to the text, what makes unaccusative verbs particularly tricky or not always obvious in surface sentences?

- (A) Their subject originally acts like an object, but through movement, it ends up becoming a subject.
- (B) They are the only verbs in English that can be overly passivized with the auxiliary *be*.
- (C) All unaccusative verbs can automatically be converted into transitive causative verbs in native English.

Question 4 How does the author position the “five major accounts” listed at the end of Section 1?

(A) As five outdated pedagogical rules that teachers used in the 1970s to correct student compositions.

(B) As five competing theoretical explanations for the origin of the error, which the paper will critically review and test against new corpus data.

(C) As five proven facts that completely solve the puzzle of “passive” unaccusatives without needing further data.

Question 5 Which sequence best captures the logical progression of the author's argument throughout Section 1?

(A) Definition of a new L2 teaching method → Rejection of 1970s Error Analysis → Statistical report on student grades → Proposal of 5 new grammar rules

(B) Emerging research background in L2 verbs → Historical shift in understanding the error's significance → Theoretical classification of the verb properties → Paper's objective & 5 candidate accounts

(C) Analysis of L1 translation errors → Comparison of beginner vs. advanced test scores → Classification of transitive verbs → Summary of pedagogical solutions

Question 6 Which of the following sentences uses an unaccusative verb?

(A) The fragile antique vase **fell** off the wooden shelf yesterday.

(B) The energetic young boy **danced** merrily across the stage tonight.

(C) The talented local artist **painted** a beautiful sunset scene smoothly.

Question 7 Which of the following sentences uses an unergative verb?

(A) Two noisy little birds **sang** loudly outside my bedroom window.

(B) A serious unexpected problem **arose** during the afternoon discussion session.

(C) The hardworking store clerk **cleaned** the dirty glass front door.